

WOMEN STARTUPS

CHECK OUT THESE INTERESTING WOMEN AND THEIR TECH-PROPELLED STARTUP EFFORTS

1 SEEKSHERPA

At 24, Sukhmani Singh decided to #BreakTheRoutine and co-founded SeekSherpa, a platform that connects locals and travelers over city-immersive tours & experiences. A NASSCOM 10K and Venture Nursery incubated startup, she worked with travel and tech industry leaders in creating this mobile first business. Previously, Sukhmani worked with AT Kearney on strategy projects in the Communications, Media, Digital and High Tech space across the APAC region. She's a travel enthusiast and a culture vulture, a keen photographer, a trained classical dancer, an advanced scuba diver and a self-proclaimed design thinker!

safety, security, hygiene, and instructor quality, criteria that are important to parents when selecting a class.

3 LOGINEXT SOLUTIONS

Manisha Raisinghani possesses over 8 years of design and development experience in big-data analytics and optimization and currently heading the product and technology at LogiNext. She has led workforces at IBM in the US and has advised global corporate clients on their technology issues for e-commerce and logistics. She holds a postgraduate degree in Information Systems Management from Carnegie Mellon University.

2 FINDURCLASS

Rina Nathani is the founder and CEO of FindUrClass.com, a leading online search and discovery platform that helps parents find the right activity or hobby class for their kids. Carving a niche for itself, FindUrClass caters only to classes that go beyond academics or are co-curricular in nature, what Rina likes to call "Personal Interest Education". With the mission of being a trusted informational resource for parents, the company not only aggregates good educators hyper-locally, but also curates them for

4 SAFECITY

Devised by ElsaMarie DSilva, from Mumbai, Safecity is a platform that documents personal stories of sexual harassment and abuse in public spaces. This data, which may be anonymous, gets aggregated as hot spots on a map indicating trends at a local level. The idea is to make this data useful for individuals, local communities and local administration. Since their launch on 26 Dec 2012 we have collected over 5500 stories from over 50 cities in India and Nepal.

products which have in the past been associated with more technologically advanced countries," says Manu, before adding, "Creating solutions which are totally home grown and developed from scratch, gives me immense pride. Technology in India is always thought to be a "follower" of other technological innovations, and busting this myth to create products from scratch which can be used across the continents is one of my greatest achievements. I have worked on products (from concept to reality) which were initially designed for developing markets but ended up getting adopted first in developed markets. This is called 'disruptive innovation' and it has helped us venture into new markets while also making our presence felt in India."

ARISE WOMEN, TECH NEEDS YOU!

Before we end this story, we'd like to leave you with words of encouragement, especially to all of you girl readers out there. Who better to inspire you than women techies who've carved a successful niche for themselves in technology?

If you were a superhero fuelled by technology, how would you fix India's problems?

“I see technology as the key tool to solve most of India's problems. Be it basic needs for increasing crop yield to satisfy the population's demand for food or working for solutions towards providing safe, clean water.

In core sectors fundamental to development like Education, Healthcare and Energy, innovation and technology can work wonders.

So If I become a Superhero, I will create more Superheroes to join me to resolve our fundamental problems that impede human development. It takes not a superhero act, but a thought-through technology revolution to transform societies and human lives.

KALYANI SEKAR
SENIOR DELIVERY HEAD, VERIZON

Megha Bhagat, from Bangalore, consults with non-profits in the education, social entrepreneurship and women in technology sector, typically spending her time creating opportunities for young girls and women in universities to get the right exposure to upcoming technology and coding. She says, "As a woman we have an incredible ability to be empathetic about problems around us and therefore remember to remain persistent with choices you make with technology studies. Technology is impacting our lives in more ways than we know and thus it's critical to become a part of the movement so that we create the solutions that we deserve."

As a seasoned HR veteran, Dr. Kiranmai Dutt Pendyala, Corporate Vice President - HR, Greater Asia and EMEA, AMD, has assessed and hired thousands of aspiring techies in her professional life. She believes that, "Technology is an enabler, do not hesitate, believe in your spirit, believe in yourself, go reach out - sky is also not the limit. Technology beckons you, take bold strides forward to design the products of tomorrow." 